

Slimmest, brightest phone

Rumours state that LG might show off the slimmest and brightest phone called the LG B at CES 2011

Phone with DDR2 memory

Pantech, a Korean company launches an Android 2.2 phone that comes with DDR2 memory; much higher performance expected

Bazaar

WD TV Live Hub

New and improved WD TV experience

Western Digital TV Live Hub has undergone

a complete redesign. The new WD TV comes much slimmer than its previous avatar and the user interface has completely changed for the better. The single colour background has been replaced by custom wallpapers with colour coded menus.

The WD TV Live Hub comes in an all black body and it houses a 1 TB hard disk within it. It has a brush metal finish on the top portion while the front portion houses a illuminating WD logo with a USB port on the right and power button on the left hand side. On the rear side you have a range of



connectivity options like component and composite audio video ports, HDMI port, USB port, gigabit LAN port among others. The remote control has a beautiful rubberised finish on the rear with a sharp projection in the centre which makes it much comfortable to hold.

HD video playback was flawless. Startup time of 5 seconds was the fastest that we have experienced. You can connect a wireless or USB key-

board to the Live Hub. You can listen to music while browsing through you Flickr photos. The HDMI 1.4 port can play back 3D content on a 3D TV which is a nice future proof add-on. We were expecting custom addition of video feeds in this new iteration of WD TV hub, but it's not available.

At ₹9,999 it is a very good buy for an HD streamer with internal storage and internet connectivity.

Specifications

Video Formats : AVI, MKV, MP4, MOV, WMV9, etc;
Ports : 2 x USB, 1 x HDMI 1.4, 1 x LAN port, 1 x Component, 1 x Composite, 1 x SPDIF; Storage : 1 TB

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Price: ₹ 9,999

6.5/10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	6.5
Build Quality.....	7.0
Value for Money.....	6.0

Specifications

OS: Blackberry OS 6; CPU: 600 MHz; display: 3.2-inches, 360x480 pixels, 16M colours; QWERTY keypad; camera: 5 megapixels; weight: 161 g

Contact

BlackBerry India

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Price: ₹ 35,000

6.0/10

Features.....	8.0
Performance.....	7.5
Build Quality.....	5.0
Value for money.....	5.0

BlackBerry Torch 9800

A few nits prevent it from really shining

At first glance, the Torch is a handsome device. Decked in a combination of matte black plastic and burnished chrome trim, the Torch is all sleek curves and gentle slopes. The Torch is heavy, on account of a vertical slider form factor. The display is a capacitive touchscreen and at 3.2-inches is the lower limit of what we consider usable.

The Blackberry OS is clearly not intended for touch-screens. We had to use the trackpad in most cases. Owing to the touchscreen, the Torch 9800 has a very nice on-screen keypad that can be oriented in land-

scape mode also. Overall, we found the touch interface pretty decent, and it's always good to have multiple interface options, as long as you get them right.

Signal quality was very good in all the zones. The loudspeaker has good clarity, but its volume is on the lower side, although still much better than the Nokia E72. Handsfree clarity is good, although vocals sound a bit thinner. The Torch 9800 has a very decent camera, in fact shots showed decent colour and fair contrast, but good focus. We recommend the Blackberry Torch, but not at the MRP. At around ₹25,000, would be a really good deal.

